

The world of Mobile Telephony was to be, then, revolutionised by the concept of the *Cellular Network*.

In the days before the Cellular Network, a mobile phone meant a phone installed right into your car. There was one radio antenna that serviced an entire city, and you needed a powerful transmitter to carry out a conversation. This powerful transmitter would occupy nearly all the space in the boot of your car, making family vacations quite the painful affair.

All changed with the concept of the 'cell'. An area would be divided into multiple cells, each serviced by its own fixed transmitter-receiver (transceiver), called a 'base station'. Now, because the transceiver was closer to you, your mobile phone was not necessarily the hulking monster it was before.

Refer the next chapter for more on cellular networks.



The Mobira MC 25 for ARP networks

The first commercial use of the cellular network, set up in Finland in 1971, was the *AutoRadioPuhelin* (ARP) Network, Finnish for 'Car Radio-phone'. It used cells for communication, but calls would still disconnect if one moved to a different cell.